

SDI Training for ICT Professionals

KoboToolbox Administration

Users, Monitoring, Exports, and Backups

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Day 3 | 30 Minutes Lecture | crd.resilienceacademy.ac.tz

User Management: Creating Accounts and Permissions

Creating User Accounts

As the admin, you control who can use the system.

- 1 Log in as the **admin** user
- 2 Go to **Settings** → **User Management** (admin panel)
- 3 Click **"Add User"**
- 4 Enter a username, email, and password
- 5 Click **Save**

Each user gets their own workspace where they can create and manage their own forms.

Form Permissions

Control who can see and submit to each form.

- Open a form → **Settings** tab → **Sharing**
- Add users by name or email
- Set permission levels:
 - **View form** – can see but not change
 - **Add submissions** – can collect data
 - **View submissions** – can see collected data
 - **Edit form** – can modify the form

Monitoring: Is KoboToolbox Running Properly?

Regular health checks keep your system reliable.

Check 1: Are all containers running?

- Open a terminal on the server
- Run: `docker compose ps`
- All containers should show status “Up” with green/healthy indicators
- If any container shows “Exit” or “Restarting”, there may be a problem

Check 2: Can you access the web interface?

- Open a browser and go to your KoboToolbox URL
- The login page should load within a few seconds
- Log in and check that forms and data are visible

Check 3: Disk space

- Run: `df -h` to see how much disk space is available

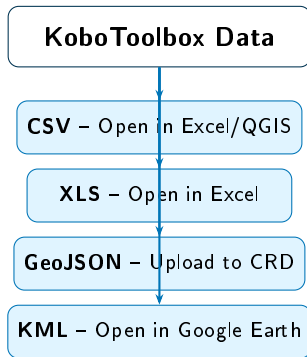
Data Export: CSV, Excel, and GeoJSON

Exporting Your Collected Data

KoboToolbox lets you download your data in several formats – all from the web interface, no commands needed.

How to export:

- 1 Open your form in KoboToolbox
- 2 Click the “**Data**” tab
- 3 Click “**Downloads**” in the left sidebar
- 4 Choose your format:
 - **CSV** – for spreadsheets and QGIS
 - **XLS** (Excel) – for analysis in Excel
 - **GeoJSON** – for GIS applications and CRD



For SDI Integration

CSV is the most versatile format. You will use it in Session 5 to bring data

Backup Basics: Protecting Your Data

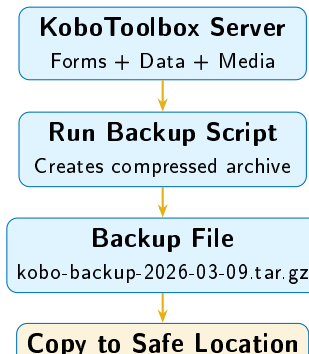
Why Back Up?

Your KoboToolbox server contains all your forms and all collected data. If the server fails and you have no backup, **everything is lost**. Regular backups are essential.

What gets backed up:

- All form designs
- All submitted data (answers, GPS, timestamps)
- All uploaded media (photos, audio)
- User accounts and permissions
- System configuration

How it works:



Updating KoboToolbox

Why Update?

Updates bring security fixes, bug fixes, and new features. Keep your installation current, especially for internet-facing servers.

The update process (overview):

- ❶ **Back up first** – always before updating
- ❷ **Pull new files** – download the latest version from GitHub
- ❸ **Re-run setup** – the wizard detects existing settings
- ❹ **Restart services** – Docker rebuilds containers with new code
- ❺ **Verify** – log in and check that

Important rules:

- ✓ **Always back up** before updating
- ✓ **Read the release notes** – check if any special steps are needed
- ✓ **Test after updating** – log in, open a form, check data is intact
- ✗ **Never update** during active data collection in the field
- ✗ **Never skip major versions** – update

Administration Summary

User Management

Create accounts, set
form permissions

Monitoring

`docker compose ps`,
check web interface

Data Export

CSV, Excel, GeoJSON
from the web interface

Backups

Run backup script weekly,
copy to safe location

Your Weekly Admin Checklist

- | | |
|---|------------------|
| ❶ Check all containers are running (<code>docker compose ps</code>) | <i>2 minutes</i> |
| ❷ Log in to the web interface and verify forms are accessible | <i>1 minute</i> |
| ❸ Check disk space (<code>df -h</code>) | <i>1 minute</i> |
| ❹ Run the backup script and copy the backup file | <i>5 minutes</i> |